SVEN LARSEN

Interim CFO | Finance Transformation | Private Equity Value Creation & Operating Partner

AI-Augmented Leadership | Founder-Led, PE-Backed & International Mid-Market Businesses

UK-Settled | EU Passport — Full Right to Work (UK, EU, DACH), No Sponsorship Required | Available Immediately

M: +44 7775 587361 | E: Sven@effigentic.com | linkedin.com/in/SvenLarsenCFO

ACA (Big 4) | Certified Internal Auditor | Kellogg–WHU Executive MBA | AI-literate | German Speaker

EXECUTIVE PROFILE

ACA-qualified Interim CFO and Finance Transformation Executive with a 30-year international finance career, incl. over 20 years in senior leadership roles. I partner with private equity investors, founders, boards and CEOs to professionalise finance functions, accelerate value creation and prepare mid-market businesses for growth, acquisition and exit.

I operate equally effectively as a Private Equity Operating Partner — building investor-grade finance functions, driving EBITDA and cash improvement and leading post-acquisition integration inside portfolio companies — and as an independent Interim CFO or Transformation Executive stabilising, professionalising and scaling founder-led, listed and other international businesses outside a PE structure. Comfortable from board-level strategy and long-range modelling to statutory reporting, audit and month-end close.

I work hands-on rather than as a consultant — diagnosing issues fast, aligning leadership teams within weeks, and implementing practical solutions that leave businesses stronger than I found them. My leadership style is empowering rather than directive: I provide context, encourage independent thinking, promote on merit and build engaged, accountable teams that embrace change.

Recent executive education in Generative AI, Agentic AI and Digital Transformation (Kellogg, Columbia, MIT) complements this operating experience, giving me a rare ability to translate between the boardroom and the data science team, to identify AI use cases with genuine value as well as the pitfalls that prevent them from scaling.

Available immediately for Interim CFO, Fractional Finance, Transformation Leader or Operating Partner mandates.

CORE EXPERTISE

Value Creation & Transformation

Private Equity & VC Value Creation • Operating Partner • Finance Function Build & Transformation • Post-Acquisition Integration (PMI) & M&A • EBITDA & Cash Improvement • Restructuring, Turnaround & Special Situations

Finance Leadership & Governance

Board & Investor Reporting • Governance, Controls & Risk • Budgeting, Forecasting & Long-Range Modelling • Working Capital Optimisation • Month-end close and consolidation • Statutory Reporting & Audit

Digital & AI-Enabled Finance

ERP Implementation (Business Central, bespoke systems) • AI Adoption & Business Transformation • FP&A Modernisation • International Multi-Entity Groups

SELECTED INTERIM & TRANSFORMATION ASSIGNMENTS

Finance Director / Managing Director

va-Q-tec Ltd. (now Envirotainer Ltd.) | UK | 2016–2026 | Global Pharma Logistics / TempChain Container Rental | Revenue >€40m, 50 staff

Situation: Fast-growing specialist pharma logistics business transitioning from entrepreneurial start-up through listed ownership to private equity ownership, before full integration into the global Envirotainer Group.

Delivered:

- Phase 1 (2016–2017) – **Professionalisation**: built Finance, HR, Legal and governance capability from outsourced bookkeeping into a fully integrated finance organisation suitable for listed-company and, later, PE reporting; built an integrated three-statement management reporting and forecasting model.
- Phase 2 (2017–2023) – **Growth**: increased revenue fourfold while implementing scalable systems and controls, including Microsoft Business Central (BC365) and a bespoke end-to-end order-processing platform; built a highly engaged, accountable management culture.
- Phase 3 (2023–2026) – **Private Equity & Integration**: led post-acquisition integration and knowledge transfer following the sale of the German parent to private equity (EQT) and its merger with market leader Envirotainer, meeting group reporting requirements faster than other parts of the business.

Outcome: Transformed a self-contained global business unit from sustained losses into the group's most profitable operation, contributing to a premium valuation and successful private equity transaction. Role concluded on full integration into and subsequent business transfer to Envirotainer (Sweden).

Interim CEO / Managing Director

Nemetschek Allplan Sub-Group | Germany | 2012–2013 | CAD/BIM Software | Revenue €60m, 400 staff

Situation: Appointed during a leadership crisis following the departure of senior executives, with declining profitability, weak morale and increasing supervisory board intervention.

Delivered: Assumed CEO responsibility within weeks; reduced external development costs by over 50%; renegotiated the international distributor network to favour new licence growth; introduced a quality-focused software release that restored customer and channel confidence; refocused commercial strategy and execution.

Outcome: Improved year-on-year operating profit from 17% to 26% within six months, restoring confidence across employees, customers and channel partners — delivered outside a PE ownership structure, reporting to a corporate supervisory board.

Group CFO | Business Development | Shareholder

IHS Group | Germany | 2007–2011 | Hospitality Technology & Services | Revenue €50m+, 350 employees

Situation: PE-backed (Kings Park Capital) international hospitality group comprising Worldhotels (soft brand), IFH (training, mystery shopping), Trust International and Nexus (reservation technology).

Delivered: Co-authored the business plan for the acquisition of Worldhotels, contingent on the parallel acquisition of technology partner Trust International, both funded by incoming PE investors; established holding-company finance, consolidation and investor reporting; steered the group through the 2008/09 financial crisis while evaluating further acquisitions and supporting due diligence.

Outcome: Created a stronger, more resilient platform that ultimately supported a successful private equity exit.

Interim Finance Director

TNI Medical AG | Germany | 2011–2012 | Medical Devices (VC-backed)

Situation: VC-backed (SHS) medical technology company facing severe liquidity pressure.

Delivered: Stabilised cash flow through rigorous working capital management; managed investor relations and new financing rounds (convertible debt, shareholder funding), presenting directly to the board and shareholders; established professional financial reporting and governance.

Outcome: Successfully stabilised the business and secured funding for continued operations; the company went on to deliver its investment case.

Director Finance & Controlling, PMO

URSA Eurasia | Russia | 2014–2016 | Construction Materials (Private Debt-backed) | Revenue €65m, 450 staff

Situation: First dedicated finance executive appointed (previously rotating managers from the Spanish HQ), amid severe market disruption following the Crimea crisis and sanctions.

Delivered: Built the first permanent finance leadership structure; ran a PMO translating 15 consultant-identified strategic initiatives into disciplined execution; redesigned credit assessment (near-zero bad-debt write-offs); secured new hard-currency banking access in Ukraine; led rapid cost restructuring alongside the CEO as the Rouble depreciated sharply.

Outcome: Protected profitability, preserved market share and strengthened operational execution during one of the region's most challenging economic periods.

CFO | Group Controller | Managing Director

Teleflex Medical EMEA | Germany | 2002–2007 | Medical Devices | Revenue €400m

Situation: Multinational medical devices group owned by a US-listed parent, requiring stronger EMEA planning, reporting, consolidation and profitability.

Delivered: Led finance, legal, administration and shared services across German operations; implemented Fast Close, SOX compliance and SAP chart-of-accounts harmonisation; simplified the legal entity structure through mergers and divestitures; led a post-merger integration and operational restructuring; as sole director of Teleflex' European Holding, managed cash pools, significant bank relationships, intercompany lending & rebilling across the Teleflex portfolio.

Outcome: Helped create a scalable European platform supporting acquisition-led growth, delivering a double-digit increase in Medical EMEA operating profit.

EARLIER CAREER

General Motors Europe (1995–2002) — Senior Corporate Auditor across CEE, Manager Cost Engineering / Product Cost, Treasurer & Accounting Manager in a large, new JV where, during an SAP implementation, I set up a functioning accounting department and workflows to achieve operational independence and proper segregation from the former parent (carve-out). Earlier professional training with Price Waterhouse (London), qualifying as an ACA.

EDUCATION & PROFESSIONAL QUALIFICATIONS

Kellogg–WHU Executive MBA · ACA (ICAEW) · Certified Internal Auditor (CIA) · BSc Business Studies (Finance), Bayes Business School, City Univ. London · Executive AI/Digital programmes in 2026: Kellogg (AI Strategies for Business Transformation), Columbia (Digital Strategies for Business Transformation), MIT (No-Code AI & Machine Learning; Implementing Agentic AI) · Univ. of Chicago Booth (Leading & Implementing Change and Innovation) · ESUG Restructuring (Germany) · Financial Modelling, PwC · International Commercial Contracts School, IPI Academy

INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

Private Equity & VC-Backed Businesses · Pharma Logistics · Medical Devices · Software · Hospitality & Hospitality Technology · Manufacturing (Automotive, Construction Materials, Medical Devices) · International Multi-Entity Groups